DEVELOPER DESIGN LANGUAGE SPECIFICATION

Website & Platform Layout Design Language

Deterministic implementation rules for the public website, AI Scan, Company Portal, Developer Portal and Super Admin environments.

Version
1.0 - Final Foundation Specification

Status
IMPLEMENTATION BASELINE

Primary Canvas
#1C4744 - Warm Deep Teal

Primary Action
#FD9105 - IO SKY Orange

NAVIGATION

Contents

This document contains implementation-only rules. Review scores, design discussion and internal decision history are intentionally excluded.

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01

Governing Principles

The interface must communicate operational control, technical maturity and clarity without decorative complexity.

Complexity
Complexity belongs in the infrastructure. Clarity belongs in the interface.

Interaction
Calm at rest. Responsive with intent.

Space
Whitespace is structure, not unused space.

> **Implementation rule:** Do not decorate an interface into looking premium. Remove anything that prevents it from feeling controlled.

Developer Priority Order

PRIORITY	RULE	WINS WHEN RULES CONFLICT
1	**Accessibility**	Accessibility overrides visual preference.
2	**Functional clarity**	Users must understand the interface and consequences.
3	**Information hierarchy**	Priority of information must remain visually obvious.
4	**IO SKY semantic consistency**	Color and interaction meaning must remain stable.
5	**Responsive integrity**	Layouts must reflow rather than compress.
6	**Visual aesthetics**	Aesthetics are optimized after the rules above pass.

02

Core Color System

These values are source-of-truth. Screenshots, AI renders, exports and visual approximations must never redefine them.

Warm Deep Teal
#1C4744 · RGB 28, 71, 68
Primary environmental canvas

IO SKY Orange
#FD9105 · RGB 253, 145, 5
Action · Intent · Selection · Strategic emphasis

Primary Off-White
#F6F5F2 · RGB 246, 245, 242
Primary light text / approved light surfaces

Secondary Text
#C9D2D0
Body descriptions and supporting copy

TOKEN	HEX	INTENDED USE	CONTRAST ON #1C4744
text-primary	#F6F5F2	Headings, critical copy	9.47:1
text-secondary	#C9D2D0	Body copy, descriptions	6.69:1
text-tertiary	#A0B0AD	Metadata, timestamps, captions	4.58:1
text-disabled	#738783	Disabled/non-interactive only	Do not use as body copy
brand-orange	#FD9105	Action/selection/emphasis	4.54:1 on teal

> **Orange rule:** if orange does not communicate action, intent, selection or meaningful emphasis, it should normally not be orange.

03

Typography System

Primary typeface: **Inter Variable**. Authority is created through scale, measure, spacing and hierarchy - not excessive boldness.

Operational Intelligence. Built to Scale with Control.

Display: 64px / 650 / 1.08 / -0.035em · Maximum measure 720px

TOKEN	DESKTOP	WEIGHT	LINE-HEIGHT	TRACKING	USE
Display	64px	650	1.08	-0.035em	Primary page statement
H2	44px	650	1.15	-0.025em	Major section narrative
H3	28px	600	1.25	-0.015em	Subsection / major component
H4	20px	600	1.35	-0.01em	Component heading
Lead	18px	400	1.65	0	Hero / section supporting copy
Body	16px	400	1.60	0	Standard content
UI	14px	500	1.40	0	Controls / navigation
Small	14px	400	1.45	0	Metadata / secondary UI
Eyebrow	12px	600	1.40	+0.08em	Uppercase labels

Hierarchy order: Scale → Weight → Spacing → Position → Color. Never color first.

03A

Responsive Typography & Text Measure

TOKEN	≥1200	768-1199	<768	≤375
Display	64px	52px	40px	36px
H2	44px	38px	32px	30px
H3	28px	26px	24px	24px
H4	20px	20px	18px	18px
Lead	18px	18px	17px	17px
Body	16px	16px	16px	16px
UI	14px	14px	14px	14px

Hero heading
Max width: 720px

Hero supporting copy
Max width: 580px

Narrative content
Max width: 800px

Long-form reading
Max width: 640px

> Body copy must not be reduced below 16px simply to fit more content. Responsive design reflows composition; it does not compress hierarchy.

Fallback Stack

Inter, -apple-system, BlinkMacSystemFont, "Segoe UI", Roboto, Helvetica, Arial, sans-serif

04

Spacing, Containers & Layout

Whitespace is a structural token. Developers must not compress approved layouts merely because additional content can fit.

Spacing Scale

4 8 12 16 24 32 40 48 64 80 96 120 160px

Responsive Gutters

VIEWPORT	HORIZONTAL GUTTER
≥1440	**80px**
1200-1439	**64px**
768-1199	**40px**
<768	**24px**
≤375	**20px**

Section Rhythm

ROLE	DESKTOP / TABLET / MOBILE
Major narrative	**160 / 120 / 80px**
Standard section	**120 / 96 / 64px**
Related content	**80 / 64 / 48px**
Standard component gap	**24px**
Large grouping gap	**32px**

Mandatory: whitespace must never be reduced merely to fit additional components above the fold.

04A

Container Architecture

PAGE CANVAS

1440px

Maximum primary composition width.

STANDARD CONTENT

1200px

Most structured sections.

NARRATIVE

800px

Section intros and explanatory content.

READING

640px

Sustained body copy.

> **Container rule:** A container must justify its existence. If grouping does not improve comprehension or interaction, use the open canvas.

Grid Behaviour

- A 12-column grid may be used internally for desktop marketing composition.
- The grid is structural and should normally remain visually invisible.
- No decorative gridlines or permanent column separators.
- Marketing systems typically reflow 4 → 2 → 1 when content width requires it.
- Reflow earlier if readable width is compromised; do not preserve column count at the cost of clarity.

05

Surface & Glass System

Glass is a material, not the default card style. Surface hierarchy must be created through translucency, blur and elevation - not visible boxes.

LEVEL 0

Open Canvas

Default for narratives, metrics, trust, simple descriptions and whitespace.

LEVEL 1

Passive Glass

Meaningful grouping without interaction.

LEVEL 2

Interactive Glass

Clickable/elevated functional surface.

PROPERTY	PASSIVE GLASS	INTERACTIVE HOVER
Background	rgba(246,245,242,0.035)	Same material family
Backdrop	blur(20px) saturate(105%)	Unchanged
Border	**none**	1px rgba(253,145,5,0.16)
Conditional edge	1px rgba(246,245,242,0.03) only if separation is insufficient	Not additive
Radius	18px	18px
Shadow	0 16px 48px rgba(5,20,19,0.14)	0 20px 56px rgba(5,20,19,0.18)
Transform	none	translateY(-2px)
Transition	-	220ms ease-out

Glass principle: Glass should often be felt before it is consciously noticed. No bright orange frame. No permanent column lines.

05A

Interaction Classes

CLASS	EXAMPLES	HOVER BEHAVIOUR
Elevated clickable surface	Solution card, service tile	May elevate -2px; icon/action turns orange; subtle orange edge.
Inline interactive	Links, table actions, nav items	No elevation. Use color/state response only.
Structural surface	Sidebar, modal shell, dashboard region	No hover elevation.
Form control	Input, select, textarea	Uses form focus/validation states; never card elevation.

Open Canvas by Default

- Metrics default to open-canvas presentation.
- Trust indicators do not require surrounding glass.
- Simple value propositions should not automatically become cards.
- No outer KPI box merely to align multiple statistics.
- No vertical separators unless they are functionally necessary.

> Before creating a glass surface ask: does the content require grouping, does grouping improve comprehension, and is the surface functional or interactive? If not, do not create it.

06

Orange Semantics & Motion

Calm at rest.
Responsive with intent.

Orange is approved for

- Primary actions
- Active navigation
- Selected states
- Meaningful hover response
- Strategic emphasis
- Selected controls

Orange is not for

- Arbitrary decoration
- Every icon
- Every heading
- Large background fields
- Universal warnings
- Decorative glow

Motion Tokens

ROLE	DURATION	EASING	USE
Fast micro-response	160ms	ease-out	Compact state changes
Standard interaction	220ms	ease-out	Hover, color, elevation, dropdown feedback
Complex panel max guideline	300ms	ease-out	Only when UX requires a larger transition

> Under **prefers-reduced-motion: reduce**, remove non-essential transforms and decorative transitions while preserving immediate state feedback.

07

Buttons, Focus & Target Sizes

Book Discovery Call

Explore Solutions

Rendered reference only. Production values below are authoritative.

PROPERTY	STANDARD PRIMARY	LARGE CTA
Background	#FD9105	#FD9105
Foreground	**#1C4744**	**#1C4744**
Height	48px	52px
Horizontal padding	24px	28px
Radius	12px	12px
Type	14px / 600	16px / 600
Contrast	#1C4744 on #FD9105 = 4.54:1	

> Do not create a second orange for hover. Keep #FD9105 and communicate hover through controlled elevation/shadow. Pressed returns toward resting elevation.

Focus

- Default dark/glass context: 2px focus indicator, minimum 2px offset.
- On orange CTA: use a dual focus treatment so focus remains distinct from both button and canvas.
- Suggested CTA focus: inner #1C4744 + outer #F6F5F2; never remove focus without compliant replacement.
- Minimum effective target: 44x44px; preferred primary mobile actions: 48px+.

08

Forms & Validation

TOKEN	VALUE	RULE
Standard input height	**48px**	Default fields
Large input height	**52px**	High-emphasis or long-form contexts
Horizontal padding	**16px**	Input/select
Radius	**12px**	Inputs and textareas
Label → control	**8px**	Persistent label spacing
Field → field	**24px**	Standard vertical form rhythm
Group → group	**32-40px**	Major form sections
Textarea min initial height	**120px**	May expand with content

Required states

Default · Hover · Focus · Filled · Error · Success where relevant · Disabled · Read-only

Label contract

Placeholder text is never a substitute for a persistent label where identification is required.

Error behaviour: use semantic color + written explanation + icon where appropriate. Never communicate error through a red border alone.

09

Functional Status System

Brand Orange is not the warning color. Functional state colors are independent from brand-action semantics.

Success · #5DC0A2
Completed, healthy, connected.

Warning · #E8B85C
Attention required, non-critical risk.

Error · #F98D8D
Failed, destructive, unavailable.

Information · #78BACC
System information and context.

Pending · #B2AFD2
Processing, awaiting action, scheduled.

Neutral · #A0B0AD
Inactive, unknown, neutral state.

ACCENT	CONTRAST ON #1C4744	USAGE CONSTRAINT
#5DC0A2	4.68:1	Status accent/text where applicable
#E8B85C	5.62:1	Status accent/text where applicable
#F98D8D	4.53:1	Status accent/text where applicable
#78BACC	4.77:1	Status accent/text where applicable
#B2AFD2	4.89:1	Status accent/text where applicable
#A0B0AD	4.58:1	Neutral accent / tertiary text

> Important states must never rely on color alone. Pair with a label, icon, symbol or contextual copy.

10

Navigation, Icons & Metrics

Navigation

Default: off-white/neutral. Hover: orange text or icon. Active: orange indication. Avoid pills around every item.

Iconography

Default: off-white / neutral / restrained teal. Interactive/selected may turn orange. Avoid heavy glow.

Metrics

Default to open canvas. Value -> descriptor → optional context. Avoid card-per-metric layouts.

Navigation Implementation Rules

- Dropdowns use restrained glass and inherit focus/accessibility rules.
- Mobile navigation preserves hierarchy; do not compress desktop navigation into an unusable row.
- Active state must remain distinct from hover and keyboard focus.
- Orange is permitted on current/selected state because it communicates selection.

Metrics Implementation Rules

- No automatic surrounding card.
- No vertical divider unless functionally necessary.
- No large outer KPI container solely for alignment.
- Selected interactive metrics follow interactive surface rules.

11

Environment Density

ENVIRONMENT	DENSITY	TYPICAL SURFACE PADDING	IMPLEMENTATION INTENT
Public Website	Low	32-40px	Large whitespace, larger typography, selective glass, narrative progression.
AI Scan	Low → Medium	32px → 24-32px	Marketing density during acquisition; platform density during execution/reporting.
Company Portal	Medium	24-32px	More functional surfaces without losing brand continuity.
Developer Portal	Medium-high	24px typical	Technical density without generic developer-tool aesthetics.
Super Admin	High controlled	20-24px	Dense functional UI while preserving hierarchy and semantic consistency.

> Same identity, different information density. Public Website, AI Scan, portals and Super Admin must share color, typography, spacing logic, material and interaction semantics.

AI Scan Continuity

Website → AI Scan → Report → Company Portal

The user must not experience a visual reset after payment, authentication or report generation.

11A

Tables, Empty States & Loading

DATA TABLE TOKEN	VALUE
Default row height	**52px**
Compact admin row	**44px minimum**
Header typography	**14px / 600**
Cell typography	**14px / 400-500**
Numeric columns	Use tabular numerals where supported
Grid treatment	Prefer surface contrast; avoid vertical cell borders

Empty states

Concise title, explanation, next action if one exists. Avoid oversized decorative illustrations.

Loading

Skeletons for predictable content; restrained progress indicators for indeterminate work; explicit progress when measurable.

Disabled

Unavailable but still legible. No active hover behaviour. Do not destroy readability through opacity alone.

Destructive actions

Use Error semantics, not Orange. Consequence-proportional confirmation is required.

12

Responsive & Accessibility Contract

Responsive design is not desktop compression. Production acceptance targets WCAG 2.2 AA.

Responsive

- Columns stack according to narrative priority.
- Typography follows responsive tokens.
- Section spacing follows responsive tokens.
- Touch targets remain accessible.
- Glass must never cause horizontal overflow.
- CTA hierarchy remains clear on mobile.

Accessibility

- Text and non-text contrast
- Visible keyboard focus
- Keyboard operation
- Persistent form labels and error identification
- Minimum target sizing
- Reduced-motion support
- Screen-reader semantics
- Zoom and reflow
- Status meaning independent of color

> No aesthetic rule may override the accessibility contract. If a visually preferred treatment fails accessibility, the implementation must use the compliant treatment.

13

Prohibited Patterns

- No heavy visible borders.
- No decorative column separators.
- No grid-pattern backgrounds.
- No permanent bright card outlines.
- No excessive glass.
- No neon/cyberpunk aesthetic.
- No uncontrolled gradients.
- No excessive glow.
- No card for every piece of content.
- No black/navy substitution for #1C4744.
- No arbitrary spacing or typography.
- No orange decoration without semantic purpose.
- No overcrowding above the fold.
- No excessive rounded pills.
- No unnecessary motion.
- No generic dashboard aesthetic on narrative sections.
- No body text below the defined baseline simply to fit content.

> **Recognition test:** remove the logo. The interface should remain recognizably IO SKY through Warm Deep Teal, controlled Orange, Inter hierarchy, spacing, restrained glass and calm interaction.

14

Developer Token Reference

```
:root {
  --color-brand-deep-teal: #1C4744;
  --color-brand-orange: #FD9105;
  --color-text-primary: #F6F5F2;
  --color-text-secondary: #C9D2D0;
  --color-text-tertiary: #A0B0AD;
  --color-text-disabled: #738783;

  --color-status-success: #5DC0A2;
  --color-status-warning: #E8B85C;
  --color-status-error: #F98D8D;
  --color-status-info: #78BACC;
  --color-status-pending: #B2AFD2;

  --space-1: 4px; --space-2: 8px; --space-3: 12px; --space-4: 16px;
  --space-5: 24px; --space-6: 32px; --space-7: 40px; --space-8: 48px;
  --space-9: 64px; --space-10: 80px; --space-11: 96px;
  --space-12: 120px; --space-13: 160px;

  --radius-control: 12px;
  --radius-glass: 18px;
  --motion-fast: 160ms ease-out;
  --motion-standard: 220ms ease-out;
  --motion-panel-max: 300ms ease-out;

  --glass-bg: rgba(246,245,242,0.035);
  --glass-shadow: 0 16px 48px rgba(5,20,19,0.14);
  --glass-shadow-hover: 0 20px 56px rgba(5,20,19,0.18);
  --glass-hover-edge: rgba(253,145,5,0.16);
}
```

> Framework-specific token naming may differ, but values and semantic responsibilities must remain equivalent.

15

Implementation Acceptance Checklist

The implementation passes only when the applicable requirements below are satisfied.

REQUIREMENT	PASS / FAIL
Primary environmental canvas uses #1C4744 without unauthorized substitution.	PASS / FAIL
IO SKY Orange uses #FD9105 and retains action/selection semantics.	PASS / FAIL
Inter typography and responsive type scale are implemented as specified.	PASS / FAIL
Spacing uses approved tokens and responsive gutters/section rhythm.	PASS / FAIL
Container widths and text measures prevent uncontrolled line length.	PASS / FAIL
Open canvas is used where grouping is not functionally necessary.	PASS / FAIL
Glass does not render as persistent visible boxes or column grids.	PASS / FAIL
Interactive glass uses subtle edge/elevation states only where the surface is actionable.	PASS / FAIL
Primary CTA uses #FD9105 with #1C4744 foreground and defined dimensions.	PASS / FAIL
Focus visibility, touch targets and keyboard operation meet accessibility requirements.	PASS / FAIL
Forms implement required states and persistent labels.	PASS / FAIL
Functional status colors are not conflated with brand Orange.	PASS / FAIL
Public Website, AI Scan and portals share the same design language with controlled density changes.	PASS / FAIL
Reduced motion is respected and state meaning never relies on color alone.	PASS / FAIL
Prohibited patterns are absent unless an explicit approved exception exists.	PASS / FAIL

Release rule: production implementation must pass the applicable checklist and WCAG 2.2 AA validation before release.